

MANIKANTH NAIK

PRODUCT OWNER | TECHNICAL PRODUCT OWNER | AI / GENAI | ENTERPRISE SAAS

India | LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/manikanth-naik-7a0615142](https://www.linkedin.com/in/manikanth-naik-7a0615142)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Owner / Technical Product Owner with 5+ years of experience across enterprise SaaS, AI/GenAI, test automation, cloud device services, accessibility, training and hiring products. Experienced in product strategy, roadmap planning, backlog management, requirements elicitation, user stories, acceptance criteria, Agile/Scrum delivery, stakeholder management, cross-functional leadership, product discovery, and release planning. Strong technical foundation in automation, APIs, cloud testing, AI-enabled product capabilities and data-driven product decisions. Delivered measurable outcomes including 40% lower manual test-case creation effort, 35% faster automation development, and a 25% increase in customer acquisition.

CORE PRODUCT MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Product Strategy & Roadmapping | Product Discovery | Requirements Elicitation | Backlog Management & Prioritization | User Stories & Acceptance Criteria | MVP Scoping | Agile / Scrum | Sprint Planning | Release Planning | Stakeholder Management | Cross-functional Leadership | People Management | Product Metrics & KPI Tracking | Customer & User Feedback | UX/UI Collaboration | Enterprise SaaS | Technical Product Management | Partner / White-label Integrations | AI Product Management | GenAI / RAG / LLM / Agentic AI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Scrum Product Owner / People Manager | FireFlink Pvt Ltd, India | December 2022 – Present

- Own product strategy, roadmap, backlog and requirements across 8 applications spanning test automation, AI-powered products, training, hiring, cloud device services and accessibility testing.
- Lead 2-week Agile/Scrum delivery cycles with Engineering, QA and AI teams, maintaining 90%+ story completion through prioritization, sprint planning, dependency management and release coordination.
- Report product priorities, delivery progress, dependencies and risks to leadership; manage and mentor 8 Business Analysts and 4 Designers, driving execution quality and professional development.
- Translate business and customer requirements (CRS) into structured user stories and developer-ready SRS with clear acceptance criteria, balancing customer value, technical feasibility and business objectives.
- Drive cross-functional alignment across Sales, Engineering, QA, AI, Business Analysis and Design teams; resolve priority conflicts, sequence enhancements and align releases with customer and business needs.
- Partner with an external technology company to integrate a third-party product as a white-label offering, owning requirements, enhancement prioritization, dependencies, implementation coordination and rollout planning.
- Use product adoption metrics, delivery performance, usability feedback and customer insights to refine backlog priorities and identify continuous-improvement opportunities.
- Led GenAI-powered test-case generation, reducing manual test-case creation effort by 40% and accelerating QA cycles.
- Led AI-powered automation script generation, reducing automation development time by 35% and improving enterprise user productivity.
- Delivered a cloud-based Device Farm for cross-browser and real-device testing, enabling scalable cloud testing and reducing dependence on physical device labs.
- Led an end-to-end UI/UX transformation that contributed to a 25% increase in customer acquisition.
- Productized accessibility testing for WCAG 2.0, WCAG 2.1 and ADA requirements, expanding accessibility capabilities and supporting onboarding of multiple US-based clients.
- Proposed and evaluated AI self-healing locators, visual testing for closed Shadow DOM, unified build architecture and multi-region deployment concepts to address automation reliability, testability, release complexity and performance challenges.

Automation Engineer and Scrum Master | Test Yantra Software Solutions, India | May 2021 – December 2022

- Designed and maintained automation test scripts for web and mobile platforms, strengthening regression coverage and release confidence.
- Served as Scrum Master, facilitating Agile ceremonies, removing delivery blockers, supporting sprint health and driving continuous improvement.
- Executed API testing using Postman and contributed to accessibility and usability validation for functional and compliance requirements.

- Collaborated with QA, developers and business stakeholders on end-to-end product quality, building a strong technical foundation for product ownership and engineering collaboration.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AI-Empowered SAFe® Product Owner/Product Manager (POPM) Certification
- CSPO (Certified Scrum Product Owner) – Scrum Alliance

TOOLS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Product & Agile: Jira, Confluence, Google Sheets, FireFlink, Agile, Scrum

API, Testing & Cloud: Postman, Device Farm, Web Automation Testing, Mobile Automation Testing, API Testing, Accessibility Testing, Usability Testing, Visual Testing

AI & Product Technology: Generative AI (GenAI), RAG, LLMs, SLMs, Agentic AI, AI-powered product features

Data & Development: MongoDB Compass, Git, Java (Basics), Microsoft Excel

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Best Solutions Award – recognized for impactful product / solution contributions.
- Best Leadership Award – recognized for people leadership, ownership and execution.
- Best Team Award – recognized for team performance and collaborative delivery.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Mechanical Engineering – Canara Engineering College, Visvesvaraya Technological University | 2015 – 2019 | CGPA: 6.6

LANGUAGES

English | Hindi | Kannada